

#### **Fourth Suit Forcing   New Minor Forcing   Help Suit Game Try**

**FSF** : Suppose the partnership has already mentioned three suits, and the player who is next to bid wants to make a forcing bid but has no bid that is really descriptive of his hand. He just bids the fourth suit (whether he has it or not). This asks partner to further describe her hand.

**NMF** : Similar to FSF, this is Responder's second bid after she makes a suit response to partner's suit opening and Opener then bids Notrump. Bidding a previously unbid (New) minor suit asks for further description.

**HSGT** : When the bidding starts 1Major - 2Major, Opener can invite to game by bidding 3Major. A more descriptive invitation is to bid a different suit; this is also an invitation to game but asks partner to pay particular attention to whether he can "Help" in that suit.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these three conventions.

Board: 1  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 4 ♠  
Declarer: North  
Lead: ♥ 2

Board: 2  
Dealer: **East**  
Contract: 2 ♦  
Declarer: East  
Lead: ♣ K

Board: 3  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 4 ♥  
Declarer: South  
Lead: ♣ K

Board: 4  
Dealer: **West**  
Contract: 3 ♠  
Declarer: West  
Lead: ♠ 2

Board: 5  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 2 ♠  
Declarer: North  
Lead: ♦ J

Board: 6  
Dealer: **East**  
Contract: 3NT  
Declarer: East  
Lead: ♠ 3

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7  
♥ A 10 4  
♦ Q 10 7  
♣ Q 9 6 2

♠ A K 10 6 3

♥ K Q 9 8 5

♦ 6 3

♣ 5



♠ J 2  
♥ J 3 2  
♦ J 5 4 2  
♣ K J 10 3

♠ Q 5 4

♥ 7 6

♦ A K 9 8

♣ A 8 7 4

NORTH cannot bid 2♥ at his second turn; that would be Fourth Suit Forcing and wouldn't show the ♥ suit at all.

With a game-forcing two-suiter he jumps to 3♥ instead. SOUTH recognizes that NORTH must hold five ♠s and bids the ♠ game.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 1♦    |
| Pass        | 1♠    | Pass | 2♣    |
| Pass        | 3♥    | Pass | 4♠    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♠ by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥2    |       |      |       |

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 7 6  
 ♥ K J 8 7 3  
 ♦ A 9 4  
 ♣ 9 2

♠ J 10 2  
 ♥ Q 10 6 2  
 ♦ 10 5 3  
 ♣ A 10 7



♠ Q 8 5  
 ♥ A 5  
 ♦ K Q J 6 2  
 ♣ 6 4 3

♠ A 9 4 3  
 ♥ 9 4  
 ♦ 8 7  
 ♣ K Q J 8 5

WEST bids 2♣ as New Minor Forcing, hoping EAST has three ♥s.

EAST does not have three ♥s and he has no other bid to make that will describe his hand any better. He cannot bid Notrump again without a ♣ stopper. So EAST rebids the 5-card ♦ suit.

WEST has nowhere to go, so passes.

| West       | North | East | South |
|------------|-------|------|-------|
|            |       | 1♦   | Pass  |
| 1♥         | Pass  | 1NT  | Pass  |
| 2♣         | Pass  | 2♦   |       |
| All Pass   |       |      |       |
| 2♦ by East |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♣K   |       |      |       |

**Board 3**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 2  
♥ 10 7 6  
♦ 10 8 5 3 2  
♣ A K 8 6

♠ A Q J 6 3

♥ Q J 5

♦ K 4

♣ 10 9 2



♠ K 10 9 7 5

♥ 8 2

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4 3

♠ 8 4

♥ A K 9 4 3

♦ A J 9 6

♣ 7 5

NORTH should not use Fourth Suit Forcing to see if SOUTH holds three ♠s because that information is irrelevant.

NORTH already knows there is an 8-card ♥ fit and enough points to be in game so he bids it.

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1 ♥   |
| Pass         | 1 ♠   | Pass | 2 ♦   |
| Pass         | 4 ♥   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 4 ♥ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♣K     |       |      |       |

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K J 8 6

♥ J 5 3

♦ 3

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 5 2

♥ K 10 9

♦ A J 6 4

♣ J 9 7



♠ Q 9 3

♥ 7 6 4 2

♦ K 10 8 2

♣ Q 5

♠ 10 4

♥ A Q 8

♦ Q 9 7 5

♣ 10 8 4 2

WEST thinks there might be game if EAST can help with the three ♥ losers. So he bids 3♥ as a Help Suit Game Try.

EAST cannot provide any help at all, so quickly signs off in 3♠ which WEST passes.

*West*

1 ♠

3 ♥

All Pass

3 ♠ by West

Lead: ♠ 2

*North*

Pass

Pass

*East*

2 ♠

3 ♠

*South*

Pass

**Board 5**

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 7 3  
 ♥ 10 8  
 ♦ Q 8 5  
 ♣ K J 10 9 2

♠ A J 8 6 2

♥ Q 9 3

♦ K 7 4

♣ 8 5



♠ 10 4  
 ♥ A 7 6 5 4  
 ♦ J 10 2  
 ♣ A 7 3

♠ K 9 5

♥ K J 2

♦ A 9 6 3

♣ Q 6 4

NORTH bids 2♣ as New Minor Forcing, hoping SOUTH will show three ♠s.

SOUTH does show three ♠s, but also shows a minimum hand so North passes.

| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|             |              |             | 1♦           |
| Pass        | 1♠           | Pass        | 1NT          |
| Pass        | 2♣           | Pass        | 2♠           |
| All Pass    |              |             |              |
| 2♠ by North |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♦J    |              |             |              |

**Board 6**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 10 7  
 ♥ A K 6 5 2  
 ♦ J 9 8  
 ♣ Q 5

♠ J 4 2

♥ Q J 3

♦ 5

♣ A 10 9 8 7 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A 9 5

♥ 10 4

♦ K Q 7 4

♣ K J 6 3

♠ Q 8 6 3

♥ 9 8 7

♦ A 10 6 3 2

♣ 2

WEST wants to be in game but doesn't know which one. If EAST holds three ♥s she would prefer 4♥, otherwise she would try 3NT. WEST bids 2♠, Fourth Suit Forcing.

EAST denies three ♥s but confirms a ♠ honor by bidding 2NT, so WEST bids the game in Notrump.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       | 1♦   | Pass  |
| 1♥          | Pass  | 2♣   | Pass  |
| 2♠          | Pass  | 2NT  | Pass  |
| 3NT         |       |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 3NT by East |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠3    |       |      |       |